

Sawyer Alston

sawyer.alston.com | sawyer@sawyer.alston.com | [linkedin.com/in/sawyer-alston](https://www.linkedin.com/in/sawyer-alston) | github.com/sawyer.alston

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Atlanta, GA

B.S. Computer Science, GPA: 3.86

Exp. May '28

- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Math for CS, Appl. Linear Algebra, Discrete Math, Prog. in C, OOP
- Awards/Honors: NSF REU Recipient, 2x President's List, 2x MLH Winner, Folds of Honor Award, Dean's List

EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Researcher

May 2026 – July 2026

University of North Texas

Denton, TX

- Won a competitive NSF REU grant to conduct summer research at UNT's Responsible AI Lab (RAIL), integrating real-time, spatiotemporal context into LLMs for dynamic response generation supervised by Dr. Yunhe Feng.

Software Engineering Intern

June 2025 – August 2025

Midwest Commercial Painting

Chicago, IL

- Improved data clarity, reduced workload for 10+ employees, and accelerated the company-wide bid process by over **400%** by creating an in-house bid-automation and data handling software with a complete database overhaul.
- Drove increased traffic and company web-presence by developing and deploying a new interactive company website, integrating SEO and modern frameworks, and leveraging frontend languages such as HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

Diplomatic Technology Intern

December 2024 – February 2025

U.S. Department of State

Abuja, NG

- Developed and deployed a regional threat-filtration system automating nationwide RSS feed collection, filtration for relevance, and compilation into a daily email **serving 7+ key embassy departments**, including OSINT.
- Continue to upkeep and improve this project, recently pushing a full v2.0 revamp, including a 2-step filter leveraging a custom logistic regression model and KNN trained on high-signal, direct embassy data.

PROJECTS

F1 Track Optimization & Lap Analysis Tool | Python, React, Vite, FastAPI, NumPy, Pydantic

March 2026

- **Won 1st place** at F1-themed CodeQuantum'26, creating an interactive data visualization tool, allowing users to upload or draw a track, then modify it, generating a heatmap, segment-level telemetry, and actionable insights.
- Engineered a full-stack system featuring physics-based constraints to compute min. lap time using forward and backward propagation with comprehensive error handling and backend caching for real-time data visualization.

Food Allergen Detection App | Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React Native, Expo Go

October 2025

- **Won 1st place** at RowdyHacks XI by building a food allergen detection app using barcode scanning and ingredient analysis, with a FastAPI backend and SQLite database to store, query, and validate data to provide instant allergen risk detection with safe alternative recommendations for their profile.

ML vs. DL Notebook | Python, Jupyter, PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib

November 2025

- Built a comparative sentiment-analysis pipeline evaluating ML versus DL approaches, benchmarking TF-IDF with Logistic Regression against an LSTM-based neural network on the Sentiment140 dataset.
- Implemented end-to-end NLP preprocessing, training, and evaluation with sklearn and PyTorch, analyzing class imbalance effects, A/B testing, convergence behavior, and inference efficiency between the two architectures.

EXTRACURRICULAR

Rowdy Creators (ACM) | Public Relations Junior Officer

2024 – Present

- Soliciting club endorsements from local companies while collaborating on year-long an ASL-to-Text project.

ICPC (ACM) | Participant/Student

2025 – Present

- Active participant in competitive-style programming, solving advanced algorithmic and data-structure problems to sharpen my technical skills while collaborating with driven peers on complex, time-constrained tasks.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend/Tooling: Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Git, Docker, BeautifulSoup, openpyxl, Ngrok, Java, C

Machine Learning/AI: PyTorch, scikit-learn, Jupyter, NumPy, Pandas, matplotlib, HF Transformers, FAISS, OpenCV

Deployment/Frontend: HTML, CSS, JS, GitHub, Expo, React, Swagger, PyInstaller